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6 new WhatsApp features

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Bazaar

Moto G (3rd Gen)

Weighed, measured and found wanting

With the Moto G (3rd Gen), Motorola talked a lot about delivering highly on the device's user experience to intended customers. Unfortunately though, the user experience is determined by the overall performance of a smartphone, and the Moto G (3rd Gen) fails in that respect, when compared to competitors.

The Moto G (3rd Gen) can deal with your regular tasks, but it is not as powerful as its competitors – oh no sir! The simple fact can't be ignored that phones like the ASUS Zenfone 2, Xiaomi Mi 4i and even the lower priced Yu Yureka Plus are much more powerful than the new Moto G, not just in terms of specifications, but the overall performance as well. It's not that the Moto G has no positives going for it, but as an overall value for money smartphone, it has lost out majorly this time around compared to its past iterations.

On top of that, Motorola also boasts a 13MP rear camera, with the same sensor as the Nexus 6. Unfortunately though, both the Xiaomi Mi 4i and Asus Zenfone 2 have better cameras than this one, with the same megapixel count. While the Moto G's camera is better than its predecessor's, it's still not very good. It can take respectable shots under sunlight, but that's about the only situation where it is really good. In addition, the Moto G (3rd Gen) sticks with the stock camera app, which means you get almost no control over the camera – no traces of evolution here.

The strength of the Moto G is in its battery and water resistance. We put the phone under water for 30 minutes and it came out with flying colours. The IPX7 rating makes much more sense on a sub-15k smartphone and adds value to the Moto G. That said, it is worth noting that the Moto G is only water resistant as long as the back cover is properly placed. When you put the back cover, be sure to check the area next to the camera. The back cover has protectors built into it, which ensures



Price
₹12,999
(for 16GB/2GB)

that the SIM slot is protected from water.

Further, on the battery front, the third generation Moto G follows its predecessors, providing good backup. The phone can easily last a day and a half on normal usage, including lots of social networking, a bunch of text messages and a few calls. Gaming on the phone brings down the battery fast, but it also doesn't heat up very easily. It does get the battery to drain much faster though. That said, it is also worth mentioning that we've seen many phones lose battery much faster during gaming.

The phone is built quite sturdily and Motorola has kept its simplistic yet functional design language. The Motorola

Moto G (3rd Gen) may not be a stunning phone to look at, but its design works. The curve on the back as usual helps you get a better grip on the phone, and this time it's aided by the back cover as well, which is quite grippy. Simply in terms of looks, the newest Moto G is nothing compared to the likes of the Xiaomi Mi 4i, but it's functional. The only problem is that barring the Asus Zenfone 2, most other phones in this price range have pretty good and comfortable designs.

So, coming back to the idea of delivering user experience, the third generation Moto G fails when compared to competitors. Motorola has tried to play the specs game in the camera department, and lost, while in other areas, it's just not good enough when compared to an Asus Zenfone 2. If you want to buy the best performer in this price range, then the Asus Zenfone 2 is what you should go for. If, on the other hand, you want a phone that has a good camera, but compromises a little in terms of processor performance, then the Xiaomi Mi 4i is the pick of the lot. The new Moto G provides only the brand value that comes with the Motorola name, and that is the only reason that anyone can have for buying it.

Prasid Banerjee



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Specifications

Display: 5 inch 720p HD; **Battery:** 2470 mAh; **Processor:** 1.2 GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon 410 quad-core 64-bit; **RAM/ROM:** 2GB/16GB, 8GB/1GB; **Expandable Memory:** Yes, 32GB; **Operating System:** Android 5.1.1

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